



Walmart Worker Dignity in 10 Retail Supply Chains Report

September 2025

Worker Dignity in 10 Retail Supply Chains

FY2025 Special Report



Introduction

Walmart takes a comprehensive approach to respecting and promoting human rights in supply chains. This includes Walmart's Responsible Sourcing program and our commitment to help address the dignity of workers in a minimum of 10 retail supply chains by 2025, collaborating across business and civil society.

Walmart's Responsible Sourcing program (described in more detail in People in Supply Chains), which seeks to ensure human rights are protected and respected and key risks to worker dignity are addressed across our product supply chains. Walmart's Standards for Suppliers prohibit forced labor and charging recruitment or similar fees and require that suppliers provide a fair and inclusive environment and take responsibility for the safety and well-being of workers. We share those Standards and other relevant policies with our suppliers, audit supplier facilities in a risk-based way, engage suppliers on any concerning issues, and investigate issues as appropriate.

This Special Report is focused on Walmart's commitment to addressing the dignity of workers in 10 retail supply chains—focused efforts to promote worker dignity in defined supply chains and geographic areas—which build on our robust Responsible Sourcing efforts.

To help prioritize geographies and supply chains, we considered:

- Internal information: Responsible Sourcing Compliance risk assessment; audit and compliance information; and sourcing and sales data
- External information: World Bank Worldwide Governance Indicators; Global Slavery Proportions Index; BSI Supply Chain Risks Reports; and government, NGO, and media report.

Worker Dignity in 10 Retail Supply Chains

Collaborating to tackle the root causes of systemic risks





While specific interventions depend on the supply chain and issues of focus, approaches within the 10 retail commodity supply chains typically include:

- **Engaging suppliers to reinforce expectations, build capacity, and continuously improve** (for example, Standards for Suppliers, Seafood Policy, Ethical Charter, Walmart Supplier Leadership Program for responsible recruitment)
- **Collaborating with stakeholders in consortia or task forces to develop and share best practices** (for example, Responsible Labor Initiative, Life and Building Safety coalition, Leadership Group for Responsible Recruitment, Seafood Task Force)
- **Investing in data and technology to increase transparency around labor practices** (for example, electronic vessel monitoring, improved working conditions data, development of a recruitment cost calculator, building a responsible recruitment register)
- **Strengthening capacity and demand for responsible labor practices** (for example, training for workers and local NGOs on worker rights, tools to help workers find and work with ethical recruitment agencies)
- **Enhancing worker and community voices** (for example, Nirapon, Life and Building Safety (LABS), and Polaris worker voice channels; Issara Institute)
- **Engaging with governments to advocate for laws, regulations, and enforcement** (for example, on responsible recruitment and migration)

To illustrate our efforts in practice, below we provide details on certain of these initiatives:

- Promoting responsible recruitment and combating forced labor in seafood (tuna and shrimp from Thailand)
- Addressing working conditions and responsible recruitment in produce (North American produce)
- Promoting responsible recruitment and combating forced labor in electronics and hard home (electronics and hard home from Malaysia)
- Promoting worker safety in apparel and home textiles (apparel from Bangladesh and home textiles and apparel from India and Vietnam)

Promoting Responsible Recruitment and Combatting Forced Labor in Seafood

Relevant supply chains of focus:

- Shrimp from Thailand
- Tuna from Thailand

We work to strengthen systems in seafood supply chains through coalitions, actions, and investments that counteract forced labor and promote responsible recruitment.

Setting Standards and Engaging Suppliers	• Seafood Policy: Our Seafood Policy outlines key requirements for sourcing sustainable seafood, including sourcing fresh and frozen, farmed and wild seafood from fisheries which are Marine Stewardship Council (MSC) or Best Aquaculture Practices (BAP) certified (or equivalent) or working toward certification or in a Fishery Improvement
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Project (FIP). We engage our suppliers on these expectations and ask them to report on compliance.

Collaborating to Develop and Share Best Practices

- **Seafood Task Force (STF):** Walmart has been a member of the board of this multi-stakeholder initiative to address forced labor and illegal fishing in the Thai seafood industry since 2015. Among other activities, STF works to develop and share best practices.
- **Leadership Group for Responsible Recruitment (LGRR):** Walmart is a member of LGRR, which provides a forum for collaboration between businesses, the recruitment industry, and governments to encourage responsible recruitment, increase ethically sourced labor, and improve protections for migrant workers through regulation.
- **FishWise:** In 2023, the Walmart Foundation funded FishWise to work with Conservation International and LRQA to formalize [a new consortium](#) to offer guidance on assessing human rights and labor issues across the seafood supply chain.
- **Multiplier:** A FY2025 Walmart grant supported Multiplier's Conservation Alliance for Seafood Solutions in the development of a scalable human rights program for the tuna supply chain by collaborating with industry, NGOs, and community-based organizations to improve monitoring and best practices.

Investing in Tools and Transparency

- **The Nature Conservancy (TNC):** A FY2023 investment from the Walmart Foundation sought to help TNC partner with Conservation International and Global Fishing Watch to prototype and test how electronic monitoring technologies in fisheries may reduce the opacity of human rights issues at sea.
- **Global Fishing Watch:** In FY2023, the Walmart Foundation made a grant to GFW to improve their forced labor risk model by incorporating more data from industry, civil society, and research partners. The grant also supports integration of the model into port control vessel-monitoring tools, improving transparency in supply chain monitoring.
- **OceanMind:** A FY2021 Walmart Foundation grant supports the development of a cost-effective approach to enabling worker voice at sea by using fishing vessel activity monitoring systems (including satellite monitoring and artificial intelligence) to help workers report forced labor and safety concerns as well as identify illegal, unreported, and unregulated fishing.
- **International Justice Mission:** The Walmart Foundation has supported several initiatives led by International Justice Mission, including the first comprehensive study documenting the prevalence of forced labor and exploitation of fishermen on Thai fishing vessels in 2016.



Strengthening Capacity and Demand for Responsible Labor Practices

- **Conservation International Foundation (CI):** A FY2025 Walmart Foundation grant aims to improve social and human rights conditions in the tuna fishing sector in the Republic of the Marshall Islands by conducting impact assessments, building local partnerships, and providing capacity-building training to protect fisher rights.
- **Issara Institute:** A fifth Walmart Foundation grant in FY2021 helped expand Issara's Golden Dreams Recruitment Marketplace (which enables prospective migrants to access and research job opportunities) across a range of industries in Thailand and Malaysia.
- **Institute for Human Rights and Business (IHRB):** A FY2024 Walmart Foundation grant supports IHRB in transforming recruitment by building demand for good practices, enhancing agencies' capacity to implement the Employer Pays Principle, and supporting research and education to protect vulnerable migrant women. The grant will help IHRB convene stakeholders, expand the [Responsible Recruitment Register](#), and focus on improving protections for women migrant workers.

Advocating for Good Public Policy

- **Government Engagement:** Walmart engages governments to advocate for policy change and the enforcement of current laws and regulations. For example, we have advocated for worker safety in South Asia and responsible recruitment in Southeast Asia through direct engagement with government leaders.
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Addressing Working Conditions and Responsible Recruitment in North American Produce

Relevant supply chains of focus:

- Produce from U.S. and Mexico

We work to strengthen systems in the North American produce corridor through investments that support fair labor practices and responsible recruitment, including by strengthening underlying systems.

Setting Standards and Engaging Suppliers

- **Ethical Charter on Responsible Labor Practices:** Walmart US and Sam's Club US encouraged their produce and floral suppliers to endorse the Ethical Charter on Responsible Labor Practices—a code of conduct that sets out guiding principles and provides a framework for responsible labor practices—and are participating alongside other buyers and suppliers in the Ethical Charter Implementation Program (ECIP). Walmart was also a member of the Joint Committee for Responsible Labor Practices, which was responsible for developing the Charter. As of FYE2025, 98% of Walmart U.S.



and 99% of Sam's Club U.S. produce is sourced from suppliers who are engaged in the ECIP.

- **Supplier Leadership Program:** The Walmart Supplier Leadership Program engages suppliers of fresh produce, seafood, entertainment, and home and apparel products to set goals and report progress relating to responsible recruitment. In 2024, over 1,000 suppliers reported progress on actions they are taking to address forced labor risks and/or advance responsible recruitment practices. Efforts include initiatives to strengthen migrant workers' awareness and knowledge around safe migration and to train personnel involved in the employment of migrant workers on responsible recruitment and forced labor prevention.

**Collaborating to Develop
and Share Best Practices**

- **Leadership Group for Responsible Recruitment:** Walmart is a member of LGRR, which provides a forum for collaboration between businesses, the recruitment industry, and governments to encourage responsible recruitment, increase ethically sourced labor, and improve protections for migrant workers through regulation.
- **Coalition of Immokalee Workers:** CIW initially focused on worker education, third-party monitoring by the Fair Food Standards Council, and a fair food premium in the Florida tomato supply chain. A grant from the Walmart Foundation helped CIW expand its program to additional crops and sectors across the United States.

**Investing in Tools and
Transparency**

- **Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars:** The Walmart Foundation made a series of grants between FY2018 and FY2024 to strengthen labor protections in North American agriculture. These efforts include advancing evidence-based policy recommendations and supporting strategies to improve recruitment and employment conditions.

**Strengthening Capacity and
Demand for Responsible
Labor Practices**

- **Labor Mobility Partnerships (LAMP):** The Walmart Foundation made grants to LaMP in FY2022 to support the growth and development of professional, quality H-2A recruitment operations in North American agriculture.
- **Avina Americas, Inc.:** With support from the Walmart Foundation, Avina Americas has built the capacity of civil society organizations to train workers on their rights in key agricultural migration corridors between Mexico and the U.S., as well as developing labor rights policy recommendations.
- **Stronger2gether:** With support from the Walmart Foundation in FY2022 and FY2024, Stronger2gether has worked to establish a responsible recruitment association for farm labor contractors, the American Association of AgLabor Providers, which advances the professional development and integrity of farm labor contractors and recruiters.
- **IHRB:** A FY2024 Walmart Foundation grant supports IHRB in transforming recruitment by building demand for good practices, enhancing agencies'



	capacity to implement the Employer Pays Principle, and supporting research and education to protect vulnerable migrant women workers.
Enhancing Worker Voice	• Polaris: The Walmart Foundation helped fund Polaris's implementation of Nonechka, a mobile multilingual tech tool to engage Mexican agricultural migrant workers and strengthen their knowledge around potential exploitation. • Fair Trade USA: A Walmart Foundation grant helped Fair Trade USA implement a partner portal that was designed to facilitate worker voice and accelerate producer engagement.
Advocating for Good Public Policy	• Avina Americas, Inc: A Walmart Foundation grant in FY2023 supported Avina Americas efforts to improve the labor migration system within Mexico-US agricultural supply chains through engagement with federal and state authorities in Mexico, training for journalists, and training on labor rights for people who have migrated or who might migrate to work in agricultural supply chains. • Woodrow Wilson International Center for Scholars: A FY2024 Walmart Foundation grant helped the Center engage a wide range of stakeholders to develop evidence-based responsible recruitment and employment policies and practices.

Promoting Responsible Recruitment and Combatting Forced Labor in Electronics and Hard Home

Relevant supply chains of focus:

- Electronics from Malaysia
- Hard home from Malaysia

Walmart works to combat forced labor and promote responsible recruitment in the electronics and hard home categories, particularly those sourced from Southeast Asia.

Setting Standards and Engaging Suppliers	• Supplier Leadership Program: The Walmart Supplier Leadership Program engages suppliers of fresh produce, seafood, entertainment, and home and apparel products to set goals and report progress relating to responsible recruitment. In 2024, over 1,000 suppliers reported progress on actions they are taking to address forced labor risks and/or advance responsible recruitment practices. Efforts include initiatives to strengthen migrant workers' awareness and knowledge around safe migration and to train personnel involved in the employment of migrant workers on responsible recruitment and forced labor prevention.
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Collaborating to Develop and Share Best Practices

- **Responsible Labor Initiative (RLI):** RLI seeks to bring together stakeholders from multiple industries that share recruitment supply chains to promote due diligence in labor practices. Walmart previously served as a member of the RLI Steering Committee.
- **Leadership Group for Responsible Recruitment:** Walmart is a member of LGRR, which provides a forum for collaboration between businesses, the recruitment industry, and governments to encourage responsible recruitment, increase ethically sourced labor, and improve protections for migrant workers through regulation.

Investing in Tools and Transparency

- **Verité:** A FY2024 Walmart Foundation grant supports Verité in enhancing the [Recruitment Cost Calculator](#) to provide accurate recruitment cost data for migrant workers to the US, Malaysia, and Jordan, in order to enable ethical recruitment practices and protect migrant workers from exploitation.

Strengthening Capacity and Demand for Responsible Labor Practices

- **Global Fund to End Modern Slavery (GFEMS):** GFEMS was established in 2017 to help mobilize financial resources, unify global partners and efforts, and improve availability of data and evidence needed to improve the impact of forced labor and human trafficking prevention efforts. The Walmart Foundation awarded a grant to GFEMS to create safe migration pathways for migrant workers in Malaysia by empowering workers with tools and knowledge to assist workers throughout their migration journey and accelerating the establishment and growth of an ethical recruiter.
 - **IHRB:** A FY2024 Walmart Foundation grant supports IHRB in transforming recruitment by building demand for good practices, enhancing agencies' capacity to implement the Employer Pays Principle, and supporting research and education to protect vulnerable migrant women workers.
 - **International Organization for Migration (IOM):** Walmart engaged IOM to better understand the scope and scale of migrant labor in Walmart's supply chains in Thailand and Malaysia and deliver training to increase awareness of responsible recruitment practices, improve the recruitment process of migrant workers, and decrease the risk of workers' exploitation. IOM trained 100 facilities in Thailand and Malaysia and trained over 90 recruiters on ethical recruitment. As a result, participants gained the knowledge and skills to help improve the protection of over 84,000 migrant workers.
 - **Issara Institute:** A Walmart Foundation awarded a grant to expand Issara's Golden Dreams Recruitment Marketplace (which enables prospective migrants to access and research job opportunities) across a range of industries in Thailand and Malaysia.
 - **Issara Institute:** The Walmart Foundation supported Issara Institute in tackling issues of human trafficking and forced labor in Southeast Asia by empowering migrant workers, transforming recruitment and engaging businesses in the global supply chain.
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	• Responsible Business Alliance Foundation: A Walmart Foundation grant helped the Responsible Business Alliance Foundation incentivize recruitment agencies to adopt ethical recruitment practices and engaged employers and recruiters in exploring an economic model to support responsible recruitment.
Advocating for Good Public Policy	• Government Engagement: Walmart engages governments to advocate for policy change and the enforcement of current laws and regulations. For example, we have advocated for worker safety in South Asia and responsible recruitment in Southeast Asia through direct engagement with government leaders.

Promoting Worker Safety in Apparel and Home Textiles

Relevant supply chains of focus:

- Apparel from Bangladesh
- Apparel from Jordan
- Apparel from Guatemala
- Home textiles and apparel from India
- Home textiles and apparel from Vietnam

We have prioritized initiatives focused on systemic risks to worker safety in apparel and/or home textile chains in Bangladesh, Guatemala, India, Jordan and Vietnam, building on our years of effort and investment to promote safety in Bangladesh, including as a founding member of the Alliance for Bangladesh Worker Safety.

Setting Standards and Engaging Suppliers	• Nirapon: We require Bangladesh facilities within the scope of our disclosure policy to be in good standing with Nirapon, an organization that monitors safety compliance in Bangladesh. • LABS: We require certain apparel and footwear facilities in Cambodia, India, Indonesia, and Vietnam to join LABS, an initiative that promotes best practices for factory safety in those industries.
Collaborating to Develop and Share Best Practices	• Nirapon: Walmart is a member of Nirapon, which develops best practices and tools for factories to manage safety and build well-functioning management systems. • LABS: Walmart is a founding member (and on the steering committee) of LABS, which works with engineering companies to develop country-specific standards for safety in factories; commissions audits around fire, electrical, and structural risks; and guides corrective action. LABS also provides training for factory workers on safety, fire prevention, and use of the LABS helpline to report concerns. LABS launched a Platform for Gender



Equity in Apparel and Footwear and integrates a gender lens through policy revision, internal and external training, and staffing.

Enhancing Worker Voice

- **Nirapon and Labs:** Nirapon and LABS offer worker helplines to ensure that those most directly affected can raise their voices and report challenges, including those related to safety and working conditions.
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Learn More

To access the full report and explore our comprehensive reporting suite, please visit: Walmart.com/ESG.

Disclaimer

This executive summary is intended for informational purposes only and highlights selected information contained in our full ESG report. We encourage you to read the full ESG report for comprehensive information about our initiatives and other activities. All data and statements are accurate as of the date of publication and are subject to change. For the most current and detailed information, including full disclosures, methodologies, and reporting scope, please refer to the complete report at Walmart.com/ESG.

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